Tutorials Exercises W3Schools app iOS & Android NEW Sign In
. CSS JAVASCRIPT SQL PYTHON JAVA PHP C C++ C# AWS

MySQL Wildcards

‹ Previous Next ›

MySQL Wildcard Characters

SHARE

A wildcard character is used to substitute one or more characters in a string.

Wildcard characters are used with the `LIKE` operator. The `LIKE` operator is used in a `WHERE` clause to search for a specified pattern in a column.

MySQL Wildcard Characters

Symbol	Description	Example
%	Represents zero, one, or multiple characters	bl% finds bl, black, blue, and blob
_	Represents a single character	h_t finds hot, hat, and hit

The wildcards can also be used in combinations!

Here are some examples showing different `LIKE` operators with '%' and '_' wildcards:

Tutorials Exercises W3Schools app iOS & Android NEW Sign In
. CSS JAVASCRIPT SQL PYTHON JAVA PHP C C++ C# AWS

WHERE CustomerName LIKE '%a'	Finds any values that ends with "a"
WHERE CustomerName LIKE '%or%'	Finds any values that have "or" in any position
WHERE CustomerName LIKE '_r%'	Finds any values that have "r" in the second position
WHERE CustomerName LIKE 'a_%_%'	Finds any values that starts with "a" and are at least 3 characters in length
WHERE ContactName LIKE 'a%o'	Finds any values that starts with "a" and ends with "o"

Demo Database

Below is a selection from the "Customers" table in the Northwind sample database:

CustomerID	CustomerName	ContactName	Address	City	PostalCode	Co
1	Alfreds Futterkiste	Maria Anders	Obere Str. 57	Berlin	12209	Ge
2	Ana Trujillo Emparedados y helados	Ana Trujillo	Avda. de la Constitución 2222	México D.F.	05021	Me
3	Antonio Moreno Taquería	Antonio Moreno	Mataderos 2312	México D.F.	05023	Me
4	Around the Horn	Thomas Hardy	120 Hanover Sq.	London	WA1 1DP	UK

Tutorials Exercises W3Schools app iOS & Android NEW Sign In

. CSS JAVASCRIPT SQL PYTHON JAVA PHP C C++ C# AWS



REMOVE ADS

Using the % Wildcard

The `%` wildcard represents any number of characters, even zero characters.

The following SQL selects all customers with a City starting with "ber":

Example

Get your own SQL Server

```
SELECT * FROM Customers
WHERE City LIKE 'ber%';
```

Try it Yourself »

The following SQL selects all customers with a City containing the pattern "es":

Tutorials Exercises W3Schools app iOS & Android NEW Sign In
. CSS JAVASCRIPT SQL PYTHON JAVA PHP C C++ C# AWS

```
SELECT * FROM Customers
WHERE City LIKE '%es%';
```

Try it Yourself »

Using the _ Wildcard

The `_` wildcard represents a single character.

It can be any character or number, but each `_` represents one, and only one, character.

The following SQL selects all customers with a City starting with any character, followed by "ondon":

Example

```
SELECT * FROM Customers
WHERE City LIKE '_ondon';
```

Try it Yourself »

The following SQL selects all customers with a City starting with "L", followed by any character, followed by "n", followed by any character, followed by "on":

Example

```
SELECT * FROM Customers
WHERE City LIKE 'L_n_on';
```

Tutorials Exercises
W3Schools app iOS & Android NEW
Sign In
. CSS JAVASCRIPT SQL PYTHON JAVA PHP C C++ C# AWS

Previous
Sign in to track progress
Next

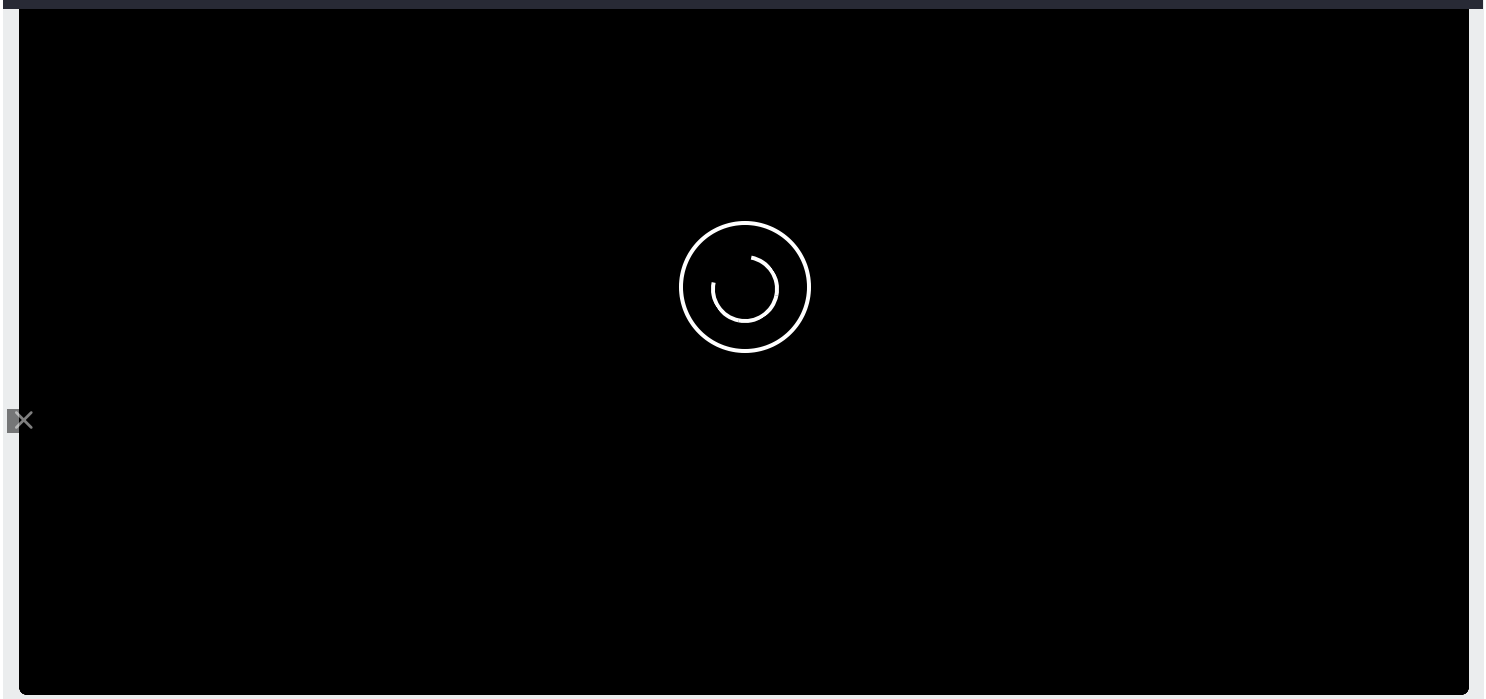




REMOVE ADS

Tutorials Exercises W3Schools app iOS & Android NEW Sign In

. CSS JAVASCRIPT SQL PYTHON JAVA PHP C C++ C# AWS



Tutorials Exercises

W3Schools app NEW
iOS & Android

Sign In

. CSS JAVASCRIPT SQL PYTHON JAVA PHP C C++ C# AWS

FREE ACCOUNT

Track your progress

XP earned	0
Day streak	0
Spaces	0
League	—

Sign in to track progress

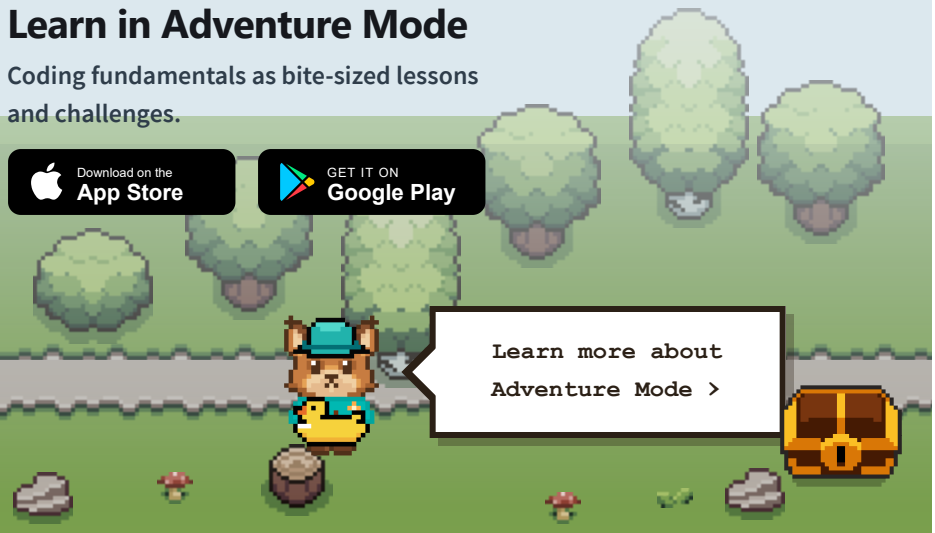
NEW

Learn in Adventure Mode

Coding fundamentals as bite-sized lessons and challenges.

Download on the App Store

GET IT ON Google Play



PLUS

SPACES

GET CERTIFIED

FOR TEACHERS

PRACTICE

CONTACT US

Top Tutorials

HTML Tutorial
CSS Tutorial
JavaScript Tutorial
How To Tutorial
SQL Tutorial
Python Tutorial
W3.CSS Tutorial
Bootstrap Tutorial
PHP Tutorial
Java Tutorial

Tutorials Exercises



W3Schools app NEW
iOS & Android

Sign In

. CSS JAVASCRIPT SQL PYTHON JAVA PHP C C++ C# AWS

CSS Reference
JavaScript Reference
SQL Reference
Python Reference
W3.CSS Reference
Bootstrap Reference
PHP Reference
HTML Colors
Java Reference
AngularJS Reference
jQuery Reference

Top Examples

HTML Examples
CSS Examples
JavaScript Examples
How To Examples
SQL Examples
Python Examples
W3.CSS Examples
Bootstrap Examples
PHP Examples
Java Examples
XML Examples
jQuery Examples

Get Certified

HTML Certificate
CSS Certificate
JavaScript Certificate
Front End Certificate
SQL Certificate
Python Certificate
PHP Certificate
jQuery Certificate
Java Certificate
C++ Certificate
C# Certificate
XML Certificate







FORUM ABOUT CAMPUS

W3Schools is optimized for learning and training. Examples might be simplified to improve reading and learning.
Tutorials, references, and examples are constantly reviewed to avoid errors, but we cannot warrant full correctness
of all content. While using W3Schools, you agree to have read and accepted our terms of use, cookies and privacy policy.

Copyright 1999-2026 by Refsnes Data. All Rights Reserved. W3Schools is Powered by W3.CSS.